

State of the Web

2020–2025

HTTP Archive Trends in Page Weight,
Protocols & Security

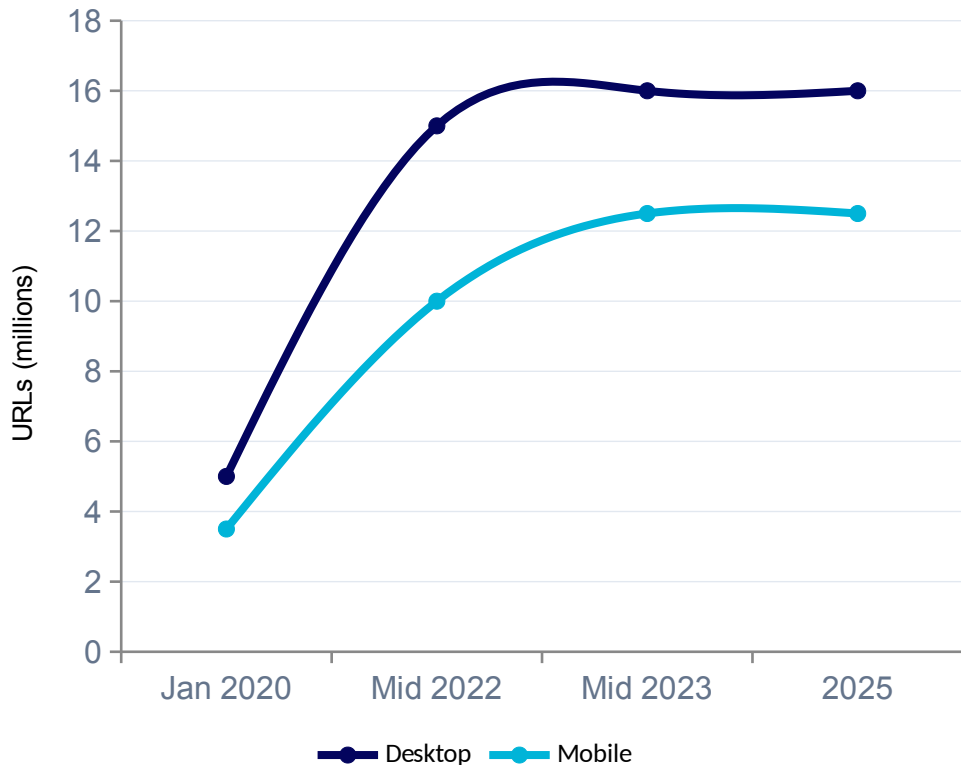
Source: HTTP Archive • Jan 2020 – Mar 2026

For web performance engineers & front-end architects



Crawl Sample Size Tripled

From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020



16M

Desktop URLs (2023+)

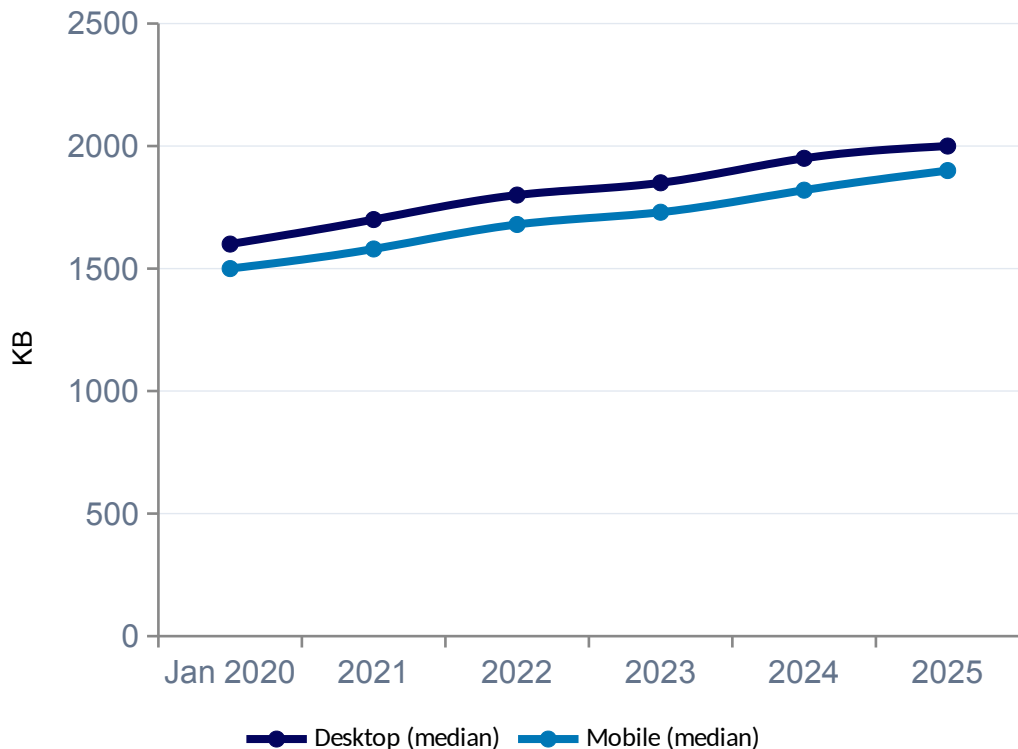
12.5M

Mobile URLs (2023+)

Sharp jump in
mid-2022 as crawl
scale expanded

Median Page Weight Climbs to ~2,000 KB on Desktop

Total transfer size rising steadily since 2020



~2,000 KB

Desktop median (2025)

▲ 25%

Growth since 2020

>4,000 KB

75th pct desktop

Mobile tracks ~100 KB below desktop

76 Requests per Desktop Page — TCP Connections Falling

REQUESTS PER PAGE

76

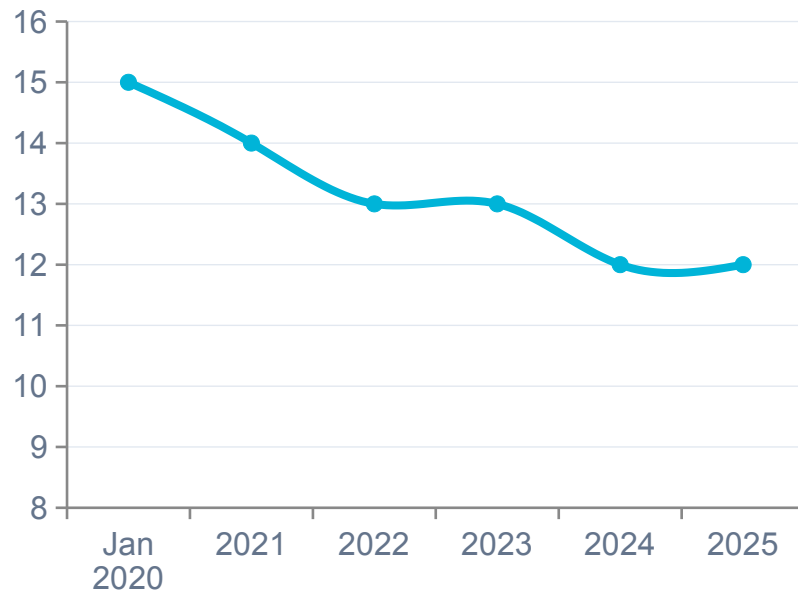
desktop (median)

71

mobile (median)

▲ 2.7% desktop ▲ 2.9% mobile since 2020

TCP CONNECTIONS / PAGE



▼ 14% desktop ▼ 27% mobile — multiplexing gains

HTTPS Requests Reach 99%+

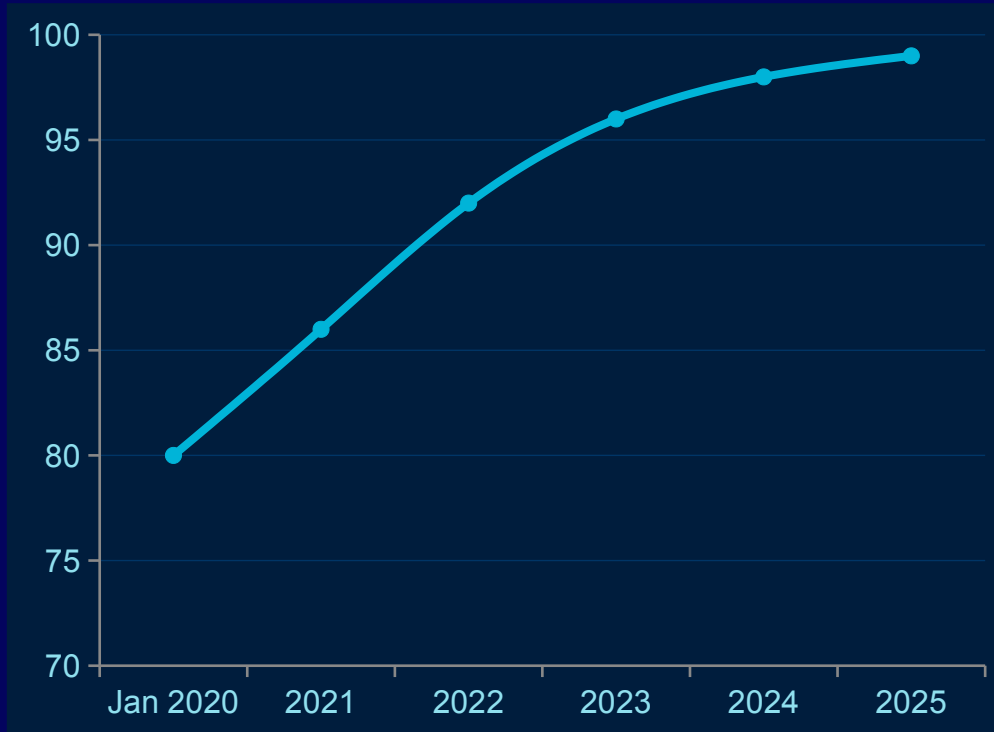
Encryption Is Now the Default

99%

of desktop requests
use HTTPS (99.2%)

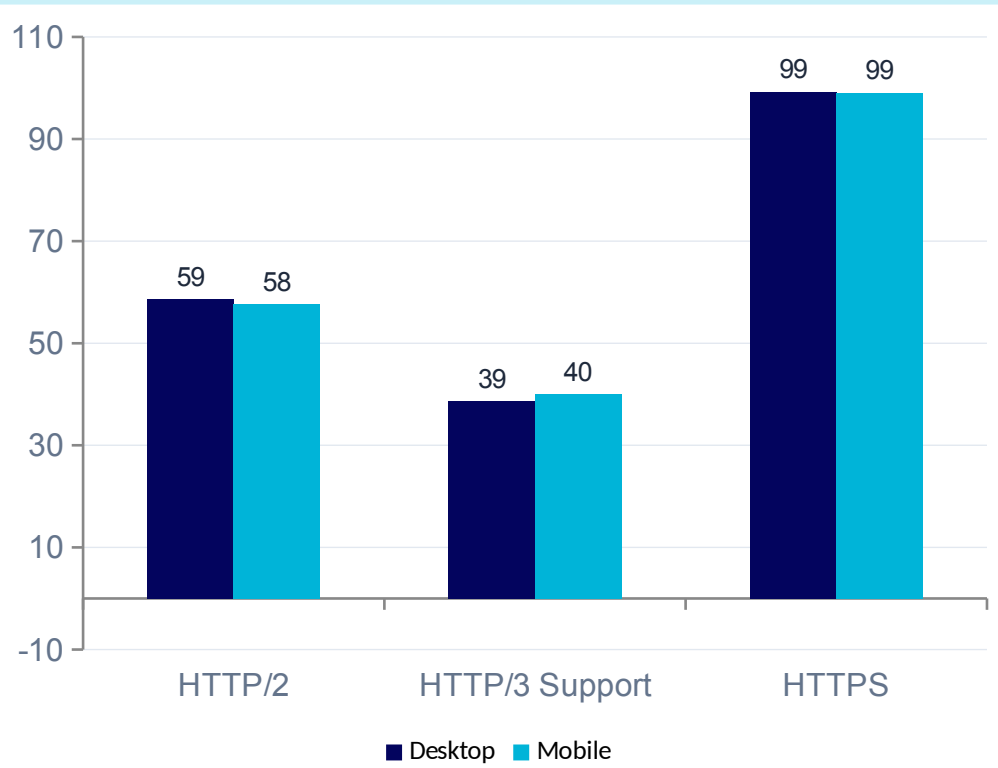
99.1%

mobile requests

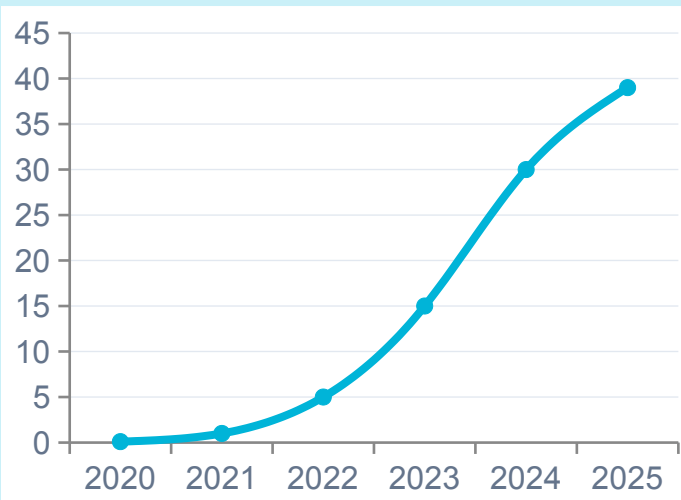


▲ ~19-20 pp since 2020 · Plaintext HTTP is effectively extinct

HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

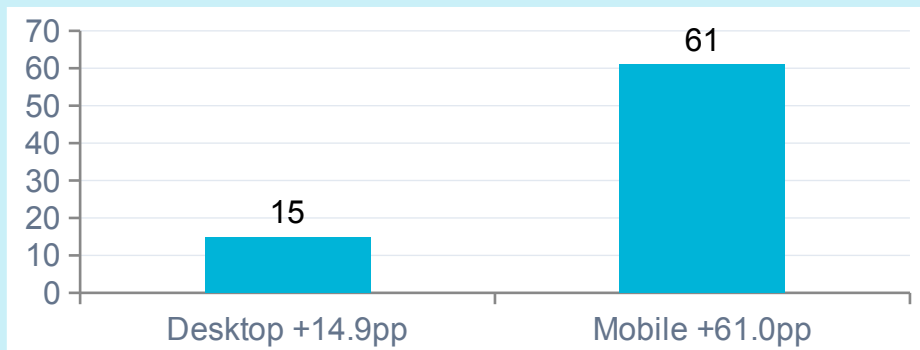
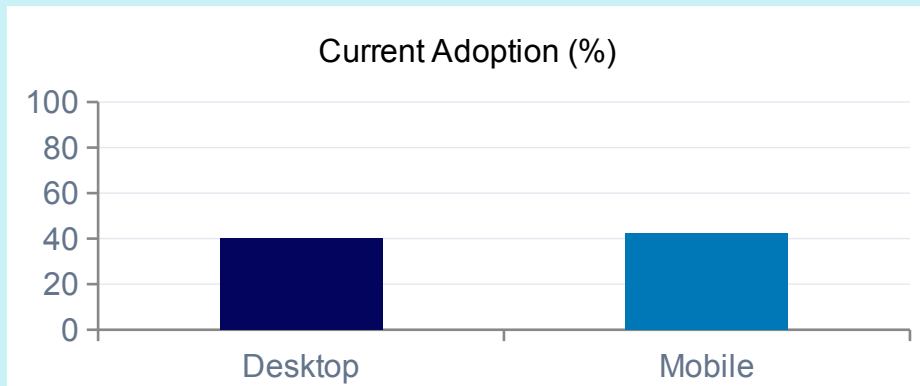


HTTP/3 RAPID RISE



Note: HTTP Archive measures HTTP/3 support, not actual usage — Chrome defaults to HTTP/2 on first connection

font-display Adoption Reaches 42% on Mobile — Still Room to Grow



What is font-display?

The font-display CSS property controls how a web font is displayed while loading. Using 'swap' or 'fallback' prevents the Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT), improving perceived performance.

**58–60% of pages still
risk FOIT**

Benchmark your site — are you in the 40%?

Key Takeaways: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

- 01 Page weight keeps climbing — median desktop now ~2,000 KB, up 25% since 2020
- 02 HTTPS is the new baseline — 99%+ of requests are encrypted; plaintext HTTP is effectively extinct
- 03 HTTP/3 is the fastest-growing protocol metric — from near-zero to ~40% support in under four years
- 04 Fewer TCP connections despite more requests — multiplexing cut median connections 15–27%
- 05 font-display still underused — only 40–42% of pages adopt it; significant FOIT risk remains

Benchmark your site against these baselines at httparchive.org